WORLD IN 1914 AND OUTBREAK OF WWI

ALLIANCE SYSTEM FORMATION → FOUR STRUCTURAL TENSIONS → BALKAN CRISIS LADDER → JULY TRIGGER AND FIRST → ESCALATION CHAIN → BALANCE-OF-POWER CASE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◇ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ★ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g4 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00 →

STAGE 00 ALLIANCE SYSTEM FORMATION

ALLIANCE SYSTEM FORMATION · TRIPLE ALLIANCE · GERMANY, AUSTRIA-HUNGARY, ITALY · FRANCE AND RUSSIA ALLY · ENTENTE CORDIALE · BRITAIN AND RUSSIA COMPLETE THE ENTENTE ALIGNMENT · MUST REMEMBER · ALLIANCE BLOCS, ARMS COMPETITION, IMPERIAL RIVALRY, NATIONALISM AND BALKAN

1882 → Triple Alliance: Germany, Austria-Hungary, Italy → 1894 → France and Russia ally → 1904 → Entente Cordiale → 1907 → Britain and Russia complete the Entente alignment → MUST REMEMBER: Alliance blocs, arms competition, imperial rivalry, nationalism and Balkan crises created structural danger

CORE CLAIM
- 1882 → Triple Alliance: Germany, Austria-Hungary, Italy
- 1894 → France and Russia ally

MECHANISM
- 1904 → Entente Cordiale
- 1907 → Britain and Russia complete the Entente alignment

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MUST REMEMBER: Alliance blocs, arms competition, imperial rivalry, nationalism and Balkan crises created structural danger
- Sarajevo was the trigger and the July Crisis converted a regional assassination into general war through state choices.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: Alliance blocs, arms competition, imperial rivalry, nationalism and Balkan crises created structural danger; Sarajevo was the trigger and the July Crisis converted a regional assassination into general war through state choices.

01 →

STAGE 01 FOUR STRUCTURAL TENSIONS

FOUR STRUCTURAL TENSIONS · NAVAL RACE · BRITAIN FEARS RELATIVE GERMAN SEA POWER · FRENCH REVANCHIST GRIEVANCE · GERMANY READS ENTENTE AS STRATEGIC PRESSURE · AUSTRIA AND RUSSIA COMPETE THROUGH SERBIA

NAVAL RACE → Britain fears relative German sea power → ALSACE-LORRAINE → French revanchist grievance → ENCIRCLEMENT → Germany reads Entente as strategic pressure → BALKANS → Austria and Russia compete through Serbia

CORE CLAIM
- NAVAL RACE → Britain fears relative German sea power
- ALSACE-LORRAINE → French revanchist grievance

MECHANISM
- ENCIRCLEMENT → Germany reads Entente as strategic pressure
- BALKANS → Austria and Russia compete through Serbia

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- NAVAL RACE → Britain fears relative German sea power
- ALSACE-LORRAINE → French revanchist grievance

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BALKANS → Austria and Russia compete through Serbia.

02 →

STAGE 02 BALKAN CRISIS LADDER

BALKAN CRISIS LADDER · AUSTRIA-HUNGARY ANNEXES BOSNIA · AGADIR SHARPENS ANGLO-GERMAN MISTRUST · BALKAN WARS STRENGTHEN SERBIA · AUSTRIA SEEKS TO CURB SERBIAN NATIONALISM

1908 → Austria-Hungary annexes Bosnia → 1911 → Agadir sharpens Anglo-German mistrust → 1912-13 → Balkan Wars strengthen Serbia → 1914 → Austria seeks to curb Serbian nationalism

CORE CLAIM
- 1908 → Austria-Hungary annexes Bosnia
- 1911 → Agadir sharpens Anglo-German mistrust

MECHANISM
- 1912-13 → Balkan Wars strengthen Serbia
- 1914 → Austria seeks to curb Serbian nationalism

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- 1908 → Austria-Hungary annexes Bosnia
- 1911 → Agadir sharpens Anglo-German mistrust

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1914 → Austria seeks to curb Serbian nationalism.

03 →

STAGE 03 JULY TRIGGER AND FIRST DECISION

JULY TRIGGER AND FIRST DECISION · 28 JUNE · PRINCIP ASSASSINATES FRANZ FERDINAND AT SARAJEVO · AUSTRIA FRAMES DEMANDS SERBIA CANNOT FULLY ACCEPT · 28 JULY · AUSTRIA-HUNGARY DECLARES WAR ON SERBIA · ASSASSINATION TRIGGERS; VIENNA CHOOSES WAR

28 JUNE → Princip assassinates Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo → ULTIMATUM → Austria frames demands Serbia cannot fully accept → 28 JULY → Austria-Hungary declares war on Serbia → RULE → assassination triggers; Vienna chooses war

CORE CLAIM
- 28 JUNE → Princip assassinates Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo
- ULTIMATUM → Austria frames demands Serbia cannot fully accept

MECHANISM
- 28 JULY → Austria-Hungary declares war on Serbia
- RULE → assassination triggers; Vienna chooses war

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- 28 JUNE → Princip assassinates Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo
- ULTIMATUM → Austria frames demands Serbia cannot fully accept

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 28 JULY → Austria-Hungary declares war on Serbia.

04 →

STAGE 04 ESCALATION CHAIN

ESCALATION CHAIN · GERMAN SUPPORT · AUSTRIA TAKES HARD LINE · RUSSIAN MOBILISATION · CONFLICT BECOMES GREAT-POWER CRISIS · 1/3 AUG · GERMANY DECLARES WAR ON RUSSIA AND FRANCE · 4 AUG

GERMAN SUPPORT → Austria takes hard line → RUSSIAN MOBILISATION → conflict becomes great-power crisis → 1/3 AUG → Germany declares war on Russia and France → 4 AUG → Belgium violated; Britain enters

CORE CLAIM
- GERMAN SUPPORT → Austria takes hard line
- RUSSIAN MOBILISATION → conflict becomes great-power crisis

MECHANISM
- 1/3 AUG → Germany declares war on Russia and France
- 4 AUG → Belgium violated; Britain enters

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- GERMAN SUPPORT → Austria takes hard line
- RUSSIAN MOBILISATION → conflict becomes great-power crisis

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1/3 AUG → Germany declares war on Russia and France.

05 →

STAGE 05 BALANCE-OF-POWER CASE

BALANCE-OF-POWER CASE · EUROPE DIVIDED INTO COUNTERWEIGHTS · GERMANY FEARS RELATIVE DECLINE · NAVAL RATIO · BRITAIN WATCHES CHANNEL AND FLEET BALANCE · EACH CRISIS SCORED AS A POWER TRANSFER

BLOCS → Europe divided into counterweights

ENCIRCLEMENT → Germany fears relative decline → NAVAL RATIO → Britain watches Channel and fleet balance → BALKANS → each crisis scored as a power transfer

CORE CLAIM
- BLOCS → Europe divided into counterweights
- ENCIRCLEMENT → Germany fears relative decline

MECHANISM
- NAVAL RATIO → Britain watches Channel and fleet balance
- BALKANS → each crisis scored as a power transfer

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- BLOCS → Europe divided into counterweights
- ENCIRCLEMENT → Germany fears relative decline

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BALKANS → each crisis scored as a power transfer.

06 →

STAGE 06 MOTIVES BALANCE CANNOT ABSORB

MOTIVES BALANCE CANNOT ABSORB · MULTINATIONAL EMPIRE'S SURVIVAL · SOUTH SLAV NATIONAL UNIFICATION · ALSACE-LORRAINE REVANCHISM · PREVENTIVE TIMING AND PRESTIGE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
AUSTRIA → multinational empire's survival	FRANCE → Alsace-Lorraine revanchism	AUSTRIA → multinational empire's survival
SERBIA → South Slav national unification	GERMANY/RUSSIA → preventive timing and prestige	SERBIA → South Slav national unification

CORE CLAIM
- AUSTRIA → multinational empire's survival
- SERBIA → South Slav national unification

MECHANISM
- FRANCE → Alsace-Lorraine revanchism
- GERMANY/RUSSIA → preventive timing and prestige

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- AUSTRIA → multinational empire's survival
- SERBIA → South Slav national unification

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: FRANCE → Alsace-Lorraine revanchism; GERMANY/RUSSIA → preventive timing and prestige.

07 →

STAGE 07 MOBILISATION AS MECHANISM

MOBILISATION AS MECHANISM · RUSSIA MOBILISES · GERMANY SEES NARROWING TIME · GERMAN PLAN · ATTACK FRANCE THROUGH BELGIUM · MILITARY SEQUENCE COMPRESSES DIPLOMACY · STRATEGIC PLANS WIDEN A REGIONAL WAR

RUSSIA MOBILISES → Germany sees narrowing time → GERMAN PLAN → attack France through Belgium → TIMETABLES → military sequence compresses diplomacy → RESULT → strategic plans widen a regional war

CORE CLAIM
- RUSSIA MOBILISES → Germany sees narrowing time
- GERMAN PLAN → attack France through Belgium

MECHANISM
- TIMETABLES → military sequence compresses diplomacy
- RESULT → strategic plans widen a regional war

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- RUSSIA MOBILISES → Germany sees narrowing time
- GERMAN PLAN → attack France through Belgium

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → strategic plans widen a regional war.

08 →

STAGE 08 LIKELIHOOD VERSUS INEVITABILITY

LIKELIHOOD VERSUS INEVITABILITY · BLOCS, ARMS, BALKAN CRISES AND MISTRUST · NOT INEVITABLE · 1905-06, 1908 AND 1911 WERE CONTAINED · JULY LEADERS MAKE SPECIFIC RISKY CHOICES · STRUCTURE RAISES DANGER; AGENCY STARTS WAR

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
LIKELY → blocs, arms, Balkan crises and mistrust	BREAK → July leaders make specific risky choices	LIKELY → blocs, arms, Balkan crises and mistrust
NOT INEVITABLE → 1905-06, 1908 and 1911 were contained	VERDICT → structure raises danger; agency starts war	NOT INEVITABLE → 1905-06, 1908 and 1911 were contained

CORE CLAIM
- LIKELY → blocs, arms, Balkan crises and mistrust
- NOT INEVITABLE → 1905-06, 1908 and 1911 were contained

MECHANISM
- BREAK → July leaders make specific risky choices
- VERDICT → structure raises danger; agency starts war

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- LIKELY → blocs, arms, Balkan crises and mistrust
- NOT INEVITABLE → 1905-06, 1908 and 1911 were contained

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → structure raises danger; agency starts war.

09 →

STAGE 09 RESPONSIBILITY AT TWO LEVELS

RESPONSIBILITY AT TWO LEVELS · VIENNA'S DECISION TO ATTACK SERBIA · BERLIN'S SUPPORT AND PREVENTIVE CALCULATION · RUSSIAN MOBILISATION AND GERMAN PLAN · ALLIANCES, NATIONALISM, PRESTIGE AND MILITARISATION · CLOSE DISTINCTION · TRIPLE ENTENTE AND TRIPLE ALLIANCE WERE DIPLOMATIC ALIGNMENTS, NOT

IMMEDIATE → Vienna's decision to attack Serbia

ENABLING → Berlin's support and preventive calculation → ESCALATORY → Russian mobilisation and German plan → SYSTEMIC → alliances, nationalism, prestige and militarisation

CORE CLAIM
- IMMEDIATE → Vienna's decision to attack Serbia
- ENABLING → Berlin's support and preventive calculation

MECHANISM
- ESCALATORY → Russian mobilisation and German plan
- SYSTEMIC → alliances, nationalism, prestige and militarisation

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Triple Entente and Triple Alliance were diplomatic alignments, not automatic identical war plans
- Italy's 1914 position and later Ottoman and Bulgarian entry prevent a static two-camp map.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Triple Entente and Triple Alliance were diplomatic alignments, not automatic identical war plans; Italy's 1914 position and later Ottoman and Bulgarian entry prevent a static two-camp map.

10 →

STAGE 10 ITALY AND BRITAIN TRAPS

ITALY AND BRITAIN TRAPS · ALLIANCE MEMBER BUT NEUTRAL IN 1914; ALLIES IN 1915 · NO BINDING FRENCH ALLIANCE OBLIGATION · IMMEDIATE LEGAL-POLITICAL TRIGGER · ALIGNMENT, OBLIGATION AND ENTRY CAUSE ARE DIFFERENT · EVIDENCE LIMIT · GERMAN RISK-TAKING MATTERED, BUT A MONOCAUSAL GUILT STORY OBSCURES · AUSTRO-HUNGARIAN, RUSSIAN, FRENCH, BRITISH, SERBIAN AND IMPERIAL AGENCY AND

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
ITALY → Alliance member but neutral in 1914; Allies in 1915	BELGIUM → immediate legal-political trigger	EVIDENCE LIMIT: German risk-taking mattered, but a monocausal guilt story obscures
BRITAIN → no binding French alliance obligation	RULE → alignment, obligation and entry cause are different	Austro-Hungarian, Russian, French, British, Serbian and imperial agency and the difference between responsibility and inevitability.

CORE CLAIM
- ITALY → Alliance member but neutral in 1914; Allies in 1915
- BRITAIN → no binding French alliance obligation

MECHANISM
- BELGIUM → immediate legal-political trigger
- RULE → alignment, obligation and entry cause are different

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: German risk-taking mattered, but a monocausal guilt story obscures
- Austro-Hungarian, Russian, French, British, Serbian and imperial agency and the difference between responsibility and inevitability.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → alignment, obligation and entry cause are different.

11 →

STAGE 11 OUTBREAK ANSWER SPINE

OUTBREAK ANSWER SPINE · SARAJEVO, 28 JUNE · AUSTRO-SERB NATIONALITY CONFLICT · SUPPORT, MOBILISATION, BELGIUM · BALANCE STRUCTURE PLUS DISTINCT MOTIVES AND CHOICES

TRIGGER → Sarajevo, 28 June → REGIONAL → Austro-Serb nationality conflict → ESCALATION → support, mobilisation, Belgium → VERDICT → balance structure plus distinct motives and choices

CORE CLAIM
- TRIGGER → Sarajevo, 28 June
- REGIONAL → Austro-Serb nationality conflict

MECHANISM
- ESCALATION → support, mobilisation, Belgium
- VERDICT → balance structure plus distinct motives and choices

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- TRIGGER → Sarajevo, 28 June
- REGIONAL → Austro-Serb nationality conflict

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → balance structure plus distinct motives and choices.

E →

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · THE AUSTRO-SERB QUARREL SPARKED THE WAR · GERMAN BACKING OF AUSTRIA WAS CRUCIAL · RUSSIAN POLICY AND REARMAMENT ALSO HELPED MAKE GERMANY FEEL · USE THE OUTBREAK OF WAR AS THE SETTING FOR · CROSS-LINK INSTEAD OF DUPLICATING · MODERN-INDIAN-HISTORY/BASIC/18 WWI-HOME-RULE-AND-LUCKNOW-PACT.MD AND BASIC/19 GANDHIS-RISE-ROWLATT-AND-JALLIANWALA.MD. · IN ANSWERS, ONE SENTENCE IS ENOUGH

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- the Austro-Serb quarrel sparked the war;
- German backing of Austria was crucial;
- Russian policy and rearmament also helped make Germany feel pressed toward risk.
- CAUTION: Use the outbreak of war as the setting for later Indian wartime expectations of reform, loyalty and postwar disappointment.

ADVANCED DEBATE
- CAUTION: Cross-link instead of duplicating: Modern-Indian-History/basic/18 WWI-Home-Rule-and-Lucknow-Pact.md and basic/19 Gandhis-Rise-Rowlatt-and-Jallianwala.md.
- CAUTION: In answers, one sentence is enough: the war globalized European conflict and
- pulled colonies into a crisis whose political after-effects were felt far beyond Europe.
- Sarajevo assassination: 28 June 1914.

LEGACY / NUANCE
- Russia ordered general mobilization after Austria moved on Serbia.
- German support for Austria is described by Lowe as a "blank cheque".
- Belgian neutrality brought Britain directly into war.
- Lowe discusses Fischer, Zuber, Turner and Mulligan within the blame debate.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels